

Richard Wooding

Staff Go Engineer · AI & MCP Tooling · Cape Town, South Africa

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff engineer with 6+ years of Go and 25+ years of professional software development across product companies, startups, and consultancies. Deep expertise in building idiomatic Go services, CLIs, and open-source libraries, with a strong focus on AI tooling and the Model Context Protocol (MCP). Comfortable across the full stack — from enterprise Java origins to modern TypeScript and Python — and experienced in technical leadership, architecture, and shipping production systems for global clients. Computer language polyglot. Based in Cape Town.

EXPERIENCE

Staff Software Engineer · SPAN Digital Innovation *Aug 2022 – Present*

Global software consultancy; works with scaling start-ups and category-defining enterprises.

- Recognised as SPAN's internal MCP expert and Extended Leadership Team member, shaping technical strategy and the open-source roadmap.
- Designed and built feed-mcp — an MCP server for RSS, Atom, and JSON feeds (Go; A+ Go Report Card, 15 GitHub stars).
- Built duckdb-mcp — an MCP server exposing DuckDB analytical queries to LLM clients.
- Built mcp-server-dump — a CLI for extracting and documenting MCP server capabilities, improving developer experience across the MCP ecosystem.
- Delivered a talk at the Cape Town ML Meetup: 'Developing a Specialised Business Assistant' — covering knowledge management, metadata, and RAG.
- Drove AI tooling adoption across client engagements including LLM-powered document intelligence and internal knowledge base systems.
- Led audit of SPAN's GitHub presence and open-source contribution strategy.
- Contributed to the Legacy-to-Cloud Transformation Accelerator offering for SPAN's Enterprise Digital Transformation group.

Senior Software Engineer · SPAN Digital Innovation *Mar 2020 – Aug 2022*

- Delivered software engineering across multiple client engagements; promoted to Staff Engineer after two and a half years.
- Worked across Go, TypeScript, and Python in a polyglot consultancy environment.

Senior Software Engineer II — Discovery Core Team · takealot.com *Jan 2016 – Mar 2020*

South Africa's largest e-commerce platform.

- Part of the Discovery team responsible for product pages, search, and landing page frontends — both API and UI layers.
- Worked in a high-traffic, high-availability environment serving millions of South African shoppers.

Software Engineer · [42Engines](https://42engines.com) *Dec 2014 – Dec 2015*

- Dali platform engineer — moved the Dali platform forward across backend services.

Senior Software Architect · [Double Eye South Africa](https://doubleeye.co.za) / [Map2Tech](https://map2tech.co.za) / [PageMan](https://pageman.co.za) *Mar 2011 – Nov 2014*

- Responsible for software and information architecture across a diverse team of enterprise, web, and mobile developers.
- Founded and architected PageMan (Jun 2013 – Jul 2014), a digital signage platform based in Century City, Cape Town.

- Software polyglot — operated across multiple languages and paradigms depending on project needs.

Software Architect · [Moonlight42](#) Feb 2006 – Feb 2011

- Software architecture for enterprise Java, web, and mobile development teams over five years.

EARLIER CAREER

Chesscube (Contractor, 2009–2010): Java and ActionScript development, Facebook integration, and virtual currencies for the online chess platform. Camara Consulting (Jan 2000 – Jan 2006): Six years as a software developer specialising in enterprise Java, SQL, and PL/SQL with extensive financial systems work.

OPEN SOURCE PROJECTS

feed-mcp github.com/richardwooding/feed-mcp

MCP server for RSS, Atom, and JSON feeds. Supports stdio, Streamable HTTP, and Docker. A+ Go Report Card, 15 GitHub stars.

duckdb-mcp github.com/richardwooding/duckdb-mcp

MCP server for DuckDB — enables LLMs to query analytical data directly in conversation.

mcp-server-dump github.com/richardwooding/mcp-server-dump

CLI tool that extracts and documents MCP server capabilities. Improves DX across the MCP ecosystem.

powerdown github.com/richardwooding/powerdown

CLI for the EskomSePush API — load-shedding intelligence for South African developers.

Game of Life (WASM) github.com/richardwooding/gameoflife

Conway's Game of Life as a Progressive Web App — Go compiled to WebAssembly.

NostalgizA github.com/richardwooding/nostalgizA

Game Boy emulator written in Go — a blend of retro gaming nostalgia and South African identity.

SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Languages: Go (6+ years, primary) · TypeScript · Python · Java · Afrikaans (native) · English (native)

AI / LLM: Model Context Protocol (MCP) · RAG · LLM integration · Prompt engineering

Infrastructure: Docker · Kubernetes · CI/CD · REST APIs · gRPC

Data: DuckDB · SQL / PL/SQL · JSON / Atom / RSS feed processing

Practices: Technical leadership · Open-source authorship · Architecture reviews · Mentoring

SPEAKING

- Cape Town ML Meetup — 'Developing a Specialised Business Assistant' (knowledge management, metadata, RAG) — hosted at SPAN Digital, Cape Town.
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EDUCATION

University of Cape Town · 1998

Knysna High School · 1996 – 1997

Grey High School · [Port Elizabeth](#) 1992 – 1996